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Lead Data Engineer

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British Citizen



Lead Data Engineer with over 10 years of experience across a broad range of programming languages and technologies. Proficient in cloud platforms such as Amazon Web Services (AWS), Multiple programming languages (Scala, Python, Kotlin, Java), and both SQL and NoSQL databases including PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Apache Cassandra, and Elasticsearch. I maintain a technical blog and personal projects related to various topics including Data and Artificial Intelligence/large language models.

Work

June 2019 to Present **Lead Data Engineer, Holland & Barrett**

I've worked for Holland & Barrett for 7+ years. Originally hired as the first full-time founding member of the Data Engineering team, working to create and maintain purpose built Data solutions and kickstart the companies Data journey.

I helped build and evolve a Data Lake and wider data related solutions including, evaluating Data Warehouse products, supporting Data Scientists, Analysts, and Business Intelligence Developers, as well as interfacing with members of the wider H&B business.

My work initially included writing ETL jobs to load data from both legacy and emerging new systems, using Apache Spark via Databricks and AWS EMR. This work then evolved to building bespoke data tools to handle these ingests using Scala and Python. As well as building solutions for internal collaboration. All this being orchestrated with Apache Airflow and deployments being done using Kubernetes, AWS SAM and Terraform. With emphasis on metrics, easy configuration and monitoring.

Recently I've created both traditional and LLM/Agentic tools to improve workflows and deliver improvements to the wider data platform.

I've designed and built a scalable GDPR right to be forgotten system for customer data stored in the Data Lake, and have been replacing the GDPR orchestration system previously deployed with a bespoke solution. I've delivered tactical and strategic solutions that saved the business significant time and money, from legacy integration fixes to robust long-term platform improvements. I have also been involved in mentoring junior Data Engineers, supporting both technical growth and career development.

May 2017 to May 2019 (2 years, 1 month) **Full Stack Software Developer, Synoptic Technologies Ltd**

I worked at a startup also known as Synoptica, with my primary responsibilities related to the emerging field of Data Engineering.

I worked primarily on the Business Intelligence product Synoptica, a product designed to generate signals around businesses via the use of natural language processing (NLP). This involved developing and supporting the use of web-scraping, APIs, sentiment analysis, machine learnings, as well as other techniques to evaluate and score businesses based on web presence, media coverage, recruitment and a myriad of other indicators.

I also helped to maintain and develop tools that used various data storage solutions including PostgreSQL, Apache Cassandra, Apache HBase, and Elasticsearch.

As part of working at a startup, I "wore many hats", and had to support my team in a variety of other tasks and maintained servers and systems deployed on Amazon Web Services (AWS), as well as other cloud providers.

Tools and internal software was built using a mixture of Java, Kotlin and Python. With Vert.x 3 being used as a microservice architecture, alongside Spring Boot. With some projects communicating via gRPC and Protocol Buffers.

Nov 2014 **Software Developer, BAE Systems Applied Intelligence**
to Worked as a core member of the Big Data Team (which subsequently became the Data Engines/Processing
May 2017 group) on key products, and award winning projects and capabilities, using a multitude of technologies and
(2 years, 7 programming languages including heavy use of Scala, Java, Apache Spark (with RDDs before DataFrames),
months) and SQL. I also used technologies like Apache Kafka, and Apache NiFi for data integrations, and Puppet for
deployments.

All the projects I worked on dealt with large amounts of data, often stored in NoSQL databases. This included a lot of experience using Elasticsearch.

Additionally, I worked on full-stack applications which involved using NodeJS, and writing JavaScript, CSS etc, along with Big Data Projects that used a more traditional Map-Reduce architecture via Hadoop (deployed on-prem using Cloudera).

As mentioned, I was a key contributor on an award winning Cyber Security project that dealt with the "mid-space"; that is detecting certain kinds of threats at national scales.

Many projects involved the use of Open-Source data as well as proprietary/government provided data sources.

As part of my role and career development I contributed to development and maintenance of internal development tools and systems including CI/CD tools like Jenkins, Nexus, SonarQube, GitLab, Docker, and virtual servers. All deployed in-house in secured environments.

August 2012 **Software Developer, IDR Solutions**
to During my bachelors degree I worked at IDRSolutions, first as a placement student for a year, after which I
September was then retained to continue to work there during my final year of study part-time as well as full-time post
2014 graduation.
(2 years, 2 I worked on both JPedal, a PDF viewer written entirely in Java, as well as a commercial PDF to
months) HTML5 Java library used within Adobe products.

This involved building a good level of technical understanding around multiple technologies including Java, PDF, and the then emerging modern web technologies around HTML5, CSS, SVG, and JavaScript. All of which was self-directed learning.

During the course of my work I exhibited at Oracle's JavaOne Conference, and also gave a brief talk on our use of the GlassFish application server.

I also contributed to a technical blog, with posts still present to this day.

Education

University Graduated De Montfort University in 2014 with a First Class Honours in Computer Games Programming (Bsc.).

College A levels in Computing, Philosophy, Sociology, and a BTEC In IT.

GCSEs 10 GCSEs at A-C grade including English and Maths.

Interests

I like to spend my spare time reading both fiction and non-fiction, writing technical blog posts (available at lyndon.codes), gardening, cooking, running, but most importantly learning new things and working on personal projects. For example; I've been learning Rust by developing a Game Boy emulator, exploring MCP and other LLM related projects, and learning how to play the ancient game of Go/Weichi/Baduk.